

JJ BERKLEY (1819–62)

Born in 1819, JJ Berkley studied at King's College, London, and trained under the English railways engineer Robert Stephenson who recommended him to be chief resident engineer of the Churnet Valley Railway in Staffordshire, England. His peers appointed him as the chief resident engineer of the GIPR in 1849. Immediately after his arrival in India in 1850, Berkley entrenched himself in surveys to link Bombay with Thana and then Kalyan and subsequently in the construction of this first stretch of

railway on Indian soil. Connecting the Ghats was his brainchild. Unfortunately, he did not live to see the train whistle past the lush green Ghats as his health failed and he died in 1862 at the relatively young age of 42. In the image, he can be seen seated on the extreme right with his colleagues Geo L Clowser (left), and Swainston Adamson (centre), as an unidentified Indian man looks on.

